

Time scores

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Idea Behind the Work

Time inevitably confronts us with change. New generations, technologies, forms of communication, and media of expression continuously alter the conditions in which we live, relate, and create. These changes introduce new possibilities, but also confusion, friction, instability, and the need to adjust. The performance situates these conditions inside an evolving room. At the beginning, the room contains a body, objects, and a set of possible actions. As the work unfolds, each action changes the situation for the next one. Objects are moved, traces appear, relations are created or broken, and the space becomes more difficult to read. The same kinds of actions return, but they return to a changed environment. Each repetition requires adjustment. In this way, the room becomes a metaphor for social and historical time: a space in which every action inherits the consequences of what came before, while also opening new possibilities for what can happen next.

Artistic Strategy

The performance takes place in a room containing the performer, a set of objects, and several decks of event-score cards. The objects may include rope, a mirror, an apple, scissors, tape, a camera, a bucket of water, a violin, paper, cloth, a chair, and other objects. The event-score cards function as the main mechanism of the performance. Event-score card is a card that contains a short, intentionally underdetermined instruction that creates the possibility of an event. For example: “Cut with the scissors,” or “Rope, only once.” The event scores carry the potentiality of an action, sound, relation, or transformation within the room. These potentialities are turned into performed events whose meanings remain open-ended and are co-created in real time between the audience, the objects, and the performer. In other words, the cards create conditions in which meaning emerges through the participant’s action, the performer’s presence, the objects in the space, and the accumulated state of the room. The cards are inspired by Fluxus event scores, where a minimal instruction can generate an open-ended event.

The performer is present in the space throughout the work and represents the body as another interactive object that carries different possibility: it may respond to the actions taking place, but does not fully determine their meaning or outcome.

Audience members enter the space and draw cards from decks of event scores. The scores are short instructions that produce actions involving the body, objects, sound, space, or other participants. The decks of cards develop in layers. The first layer contains minimal instructions, such as: “spill,” “cut,” “tie,” “wait,” “bite,” “record,” “listen,” “touch,” “carry,” “drop,” “cover,” “repeat,” or “make a sound.” These cards introduce simple gestures without determining their meaning. At this stage, the action remains close to pure potentiality: a verb, an object, a body, and a room. The second layer introduces relations between objects, traces, and participants. These cards may read: “Tie together two things that were previously separate,” “Cut two connected pieces, only once and three times more,” “Direct mirror at someone who is not expecting”, “Record something which stands opposite to what you wanted to record”, “Bite on the apple and leave it there somewhere,” “Repeat a gesture performed by someone else,” or “Use the tape to hold together two unrelated things.” The third layer introduces memory, consequence, and repair. These cards may read: “Repair something without returning it to its original state,” “Pour water where something has been removed,” “Repeat an action until it changes meaning,” “Record what is disappearing,” “Cut only if another connection is made,” “Move one trace and leave another in its place,” “Use the mirror to show what time has changed,” “Return to an object that has already been used,” “Make a sound for something that is no longer present,” or “Choose one previous action and transform its consequence.” Each new progression increases both the complexity of the situation and the number of possible responses available within it.

In this way, the same type of action returns, but it is never performed under the same conditions. For example: In the first layer, the card contains a bare action: “Cut.” In the second layer, the same action becomes relational: “Cut something that connects two things.” In the third layer, the action becomes temporal: “Cut only if another connection is made.”

The work emphasizes the conditions changed under the temporal unravelling. At the beginning, the scores can be performed in a relatively direct way. As time passes, objects are moved, water is spilled, materials are cut or tied, sounds are produced, traces accumulate, and previous actions remain visible in the space. The room becomes increasingly complex.

Later scores require participants to respond to this accumulated situation. A score such as ‘cut’ no longer refers to an abstract action, but to a room in which relations may already have been made. A score such as ‘spill the water’ changes meaning depending on what has already been dismantled, moved, recorded, or displaced. In this way, repetition becomes a measure of time: the same score returns, but the room to which it returns has changed.